

Expressionism

Around the same time that the Fauves produced their vibrant, expressive paintings in France, German artists also began producing passionate, energetic and non-naturalistic art. Expressionism, as it came to be called, developed from a feeling of unrest in the country, and emerged as powerful, candid and personal depictions of individual artists' viewpoints. Without any one, specific style, the movement was subjective and impassioned.

The word Expressionism was used to describe the ideas that some artists were portraying with graphic, often brutal and distorted images. They used colours and compositions for emotional significance, aiming to convey their feelings rather than the objective portrayals of Impressionism. Expressionists admired movements such as Symbolism and artists including Van Gogh, Munch and James Ensor (1860–1949). Although it appeared almost simultaneously in various cities across Germany, it was not the product of one unified group, and many of those described as Expressionists did not know each other, or even accept the name.



Marc, *Deer in the Forest I*, 1913